



The new Google+ Events allow you to host your own offline and online events

visible by, say, hovering your mouse over a picture.

The new “activity drawer” located below a post helps mask numbers as well. Click on the drawer, and you’ll see a list of people who’ve +1ed and reshared the post in question.

Go to a person’s profile, and you’ll see a small circular icon next to their name. Hover the mouse over it, and you’ll be able to view the Circle status between you two. A single left arrow indicates you’re being followed. Two arrows, left and right, indicate you’re both following each other. If email is enabled, you can click an email icon to directly mail them.

A small gray overlay has been introduced for viewing photos. When viewing an image, the overlay will display other photos from the same user. Hover the mouse over a video, and the overlay displays the title, which you can click on to view the video link.

Change cover photo

You can now do away with the scrapbook photos of before, and have a large banner on your profile, a la Facebook. For this go to your profile ribbon. Once on your profile, hover the mouse over the banner. Click “Change cover photo”. You now

have options for uploading your own photo or choosing from the ones available. Hit save and you’ll be able to resize the photo as you like.

Set up events

“Events” is a brand-new feature, which encompasses your invitations to Hangouts, real world events and online events.

To create your own event, just navigate to the events ribbon. On the upper right corner, click on “Create Event”. This will bring up a menu, with which you can choose the theme. It seems minor, but a lot of them are animated, which looks great. You can of course add your own images as well.

Set a title for the event and date/time (synced to your Google Calendar to avoid any conflicting dates), details of the event, etc in the blank fields. You can invite people through circles or email IDs - even if they’re not on Google+.



You can upload your own images for the new Cover Photo

Click on “Event Options” to bring up the more advanced features, which include Google+ Hangout (that makes it online only), “On-Air” (so it’ll be broadcast on Google+ and Youtube) and adding additional fields. This includes fields for a website URL, YouTube links, details for reaching a place and more. Once done, just hit “Invite” and you’re set.

Explore party mode

One of the upcoming JellyBean’s features is “Party Mode” which allows pictures and media taken by members attending the event to be automatically associated

when you’ve arrived. From here, any photos and videos you take will be automatically uploaded to the event page. Party Mode automatically shuts off when the event ends, but you can also choose to disable it any time via the pull down menu in Android.

Keep an eye on trending topics

Trending topics has also been added, for all the Tweepie out there. To the left of your stream, you’ll see a small bar indicating the top trending topics on Google+.

Click on any topic, and you’ll be able to view related posts, as well as create a new post on the same for other viewers. An interesting options is being able to save your search for a topic. Look next to the Settings icon when you’re on a topic’s page and hit “Save this Search”. You can now navigate directly to that



Uncircle Inactives helps you remove inactive circles easily

with said event and appear on that page. Live Slideshow does something similar: hit “Play live slideshow, located above the title of the hangout/event, and you’ll be able to view photos of the event, as they’re being uploaded, in an automated slideshow.

To enable Party Mode, simply accept an event invite from your mobile. You’ll receive the option to enable it, and it will also notify people in real time

page from the notifications filter above your status bar.

You can also head to the explore ribbon for a few suggestions for Circles along with an expanded list of trending topics.

Extensions and Plug-Ins

Uncircle Inactives+ is a Chrome app that allows you to remove inactive users from your Google+ network. Install the application and specify a “No posts since” date, and this will show who hasn’t posted since then, thus allowing you to clean them out faster.

The new YouTube app adds playlists to hang-outs. Search for the videos within the hangout using the Youtube application, and click “Add videos to playlist” for the entire group to view. You can also save the